SCHOOL POLICIES

Horizon International School

HORIZON INTERNATIONAL SCHOOLS
Riyadh – Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

HORIZON INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

SCHOOL POLICIES MANUAL

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose

The policies detailed in this manual form the foundation of Horizon International School's constitutional principles. The aim of these policies is to achieve a world-class inclusive education system that provides learning opportunities of equal quality to all children and school students. These policies are consistent with international educational goals and are designed to ensure all students have fair access to a quality education environment enabling them to learn successfully and participate in society.

1.2 Key Objectives

The key objectives of HIS policies are to:

- Improve educational opportunities and outcomes for students with all educational needs.
- Ensure there is a clear, consistent, and predictable resourcing framework for quality education.
- Provide equitable learning opportunities for all students regardless of their race or religion.
- Assist in enabling teachers and school staff to achieve expected learning outcomes.

1.3 Stakeholder Commitment

All school stakeholders (staff, students, parents, owners) are involved in these policies and are requested to comply with every principle mentioned. Respect and commitment to these policies will ensure successful achievement of anticipated learning outcomes.

1.4 Scope

This manual applies to all school operations and behaviors:

- On school premises, on school buses, and during school-authorized events.
- During school hours and when student conduct impacts school welfare (including digital communications).

2. LEARNING AND TEACHING POLICY

2.1 Policy Statement

The Learning and Teaching Policy aims to ensure students are provided with high-quality learning experiences that foster intellectual independence and transferable skills on a life-long basis. A wide variety of learning methods, within a set of clear expectations, is encouraged through teaching styles and strategies designed to challenge and engage all students and prepare them for global citizenship in the twenty-first century. Teaching and learning are seen as cooperative teamwork where good practice and innovation are encouraged and shared across the school.

2.2 Aims

This policy aims to:

- Support and put into practice the aims and values expressed in the school purpose.
- Embrace a culture throughout the school that expects teachers to reflect on teaching methods and practices.
- State school expectations regarding teaching and learning.
- Ensure teaching goals reflect student learning needs.
- Ensure students attain their full potential as learners.
- Help students develop into learners who are respectful, supportive, adaptable, independent, and effective communicators.
- Maintain an environment in which students feel valued, happy, and successful.
- Promote a range of teaching and learning experiences that makes effective use of a variety of resources and teaching styles.
- Ensure teaching reflects an understanding of different intelligences.
- Share good practice effectively across the whole school.
- Provide a basis by which programs can be developed to monitor teaching and learning effectiveness.

2.3 Lesson Structure Expectations

Lesson structure should:

- Connect learning to students' existing knowledge.
- Link learning to students' lives.
- Give students the "big picture" of what they will be learning and opportunities to extend learning through differentiated home learning activities.
- Ensure learning objectives are shared and understood by students.
- Deliver inputs and provide activities catering for a variety of learning styles.
- Provide opportunities for students to demonstrate understanding through reflection and evaluation.
- Assess, review, and revise learning regularly through methods including higher-order questioning.
- Use differentiated resources, tasks, and activities imaginatively.
- Provide opportunities for student leadership, independent learning, problem solving, and critical thinking.
- Ensure time is used productively.

2.4 Feedback to Students

Feedback should:

- Build self-esteem through sensitive constructive comments.
- Where possible, be immediate.
- Encourage, motivate, and reward.
- Support student development and progress.
- Be explicit and relevant to lesson aims.
- Identify misunderstandings and gaps in learning.
- Show progress against learning objectives and student targets.
- Provide insight on how to improve further.

2.5 Planning, Instruction, and Assessment

2.5.1 Planning and Preparation

Teachers should prepare:

- Curriculum mapping to clarify objectives, standards, and sequencing.
- Daily lesson plans written in the lesson plan booklet.
- Standards-based worksheets and resources.
- Assessment tools (graded and non-graded) prepared before instruction.
- Home letters informing parents of expected skills when required.
- Instructional tools: textbook, teacher edition, cards, project materials, and necessary objects.

2.5.2 Instruction

Teachers should:

- Teach skills and standards, not pages.
- Follow teacher edition guidance for topic division and instructional flow.
- Use varied strategies emphasizing student-centered learning.
- Integrate projects as part of participation and assessment.

Suggested engagement strategies include:

- Project-based learning, problem-solving learning, task-based learning
- Small groups, role play, semantic mapping, brainstorming, dramatization, presentations

2.5.3 Assessment

Assessment is an ongoing process that informs planning and delivery. Teachers evaluate students through observation, participation, questioning, homework, projects, oral recitations, quizzes, and formal examinations.

Continuous assessment includes:

- Formal testing, observation, research tasks, oral tasks, group activities, quizzes

Purpose of assessment

- Assist student learning

- Identify strengths and weaknesses
- Assess instructional strategy effectiveness
- Improve curriculum programs and teaching effectiveness
- Provide data for decision-making
- Communicate with and involve the community

Types of assessment

- Diagnostic assessment (prior to instruction)
- Formative assessment (assessment for learning)
- Summative assessment (assessment of learning)

2.6 Mark Distribution

At Horizon International School, student performance is evaluated through:

1. Participation: Attendance, Homework, Interaction, Project, Behavior
2. Quizzes
3. Midterm test
4. Final exam

The marks distribution booklet is provided by the coordinator at the beginning of the year.

2.7 Progress Reports

- Findings must follow assessments.
- Student performance is monitored for improvement or drawback.
- Progress reports monitor growth toward academic standards and schoolwide learner outcomes.
- The counselor coordinates the progress-report process.
- Parents are informed of student progress.
- Plans, strategies, and resources are adjusted based on results.

3. EQUAL OPPORTUNITY POLICY

3.1 Rationale

The school's vision and mission commit the school to accept, embrace and celebrate cultural diversity while promoting respect, honesty, compassion, and kindness. Equal opportunities are central to the school ethos.

3.2 Aims

- Develop a positive self-image for all community members.
- Ensure quality of opportunity regardless of race, ethnicity, religion, or background.
- Establish an environment where cultures and beliefs are respected and viewed as enrichment.
- Prepare students for life in a culturally plural society.
- Eliminate harassment, unfair discrimination, and injustice.

3.3 Roles and Responsibilities

School Administration will:

- Ensure staff are aware of and implement this policy.
- Reflect diverse positive values across school life.
- Treat discrimination and racial harassment as serious disciplinary matters.
- Ensure all community members are respected and cultures are valued.
- Provide training and take action when incidents arise.

Academic Coordinators will:

- Review curriculum content and materials to ensure no prejudice.
- Ensure planning considers age, ability, gender, ethnicity, background, and special needs.
- Promote a broad, positive multicultural approach.

Teachers will:

- List students alphabetically without discrimination.
- Monitor welfare and report incidents to section supervisors.

Students will:

- Respect others regardless of differences.
- Report incidents to class teachers.

Parents will:

- Support and respect the equal opportunity policy.

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4. SLOW LEARNERS POLICY

4.1 Statement

HIS supports students who experience slower learning progress through targeted strategies, patience, and structured intervention.

4.2 Identification

Slow learners may:

- Perform below grade level despite effort
- Have short attention span, slower processing, and low achievement
- Struggle with multi-step instructions and higher-order thinking

4.3 Support Tools and Techniques

Teachers implement:

1. Classroom interventions: repetition, simplified tasks, confidence building, real-life connections, lower standard-based questions, extra worksheets.
2. Relationship support: private discussions and parent communication to identify barriers.
3. Motivation plan: achievable goals, participation, praise, seating adjustments, peer support, organization support, frequent name use.
4. Extra time/work: small-group mentoring, break-time support, ability-matched homework.
5. Repeat standards: track and reteach standards not met.
6. Lower the standards when necessary to achieve minimum mastery.

4.4 Assessment Guidance

Use realistic assessment methods:

- Short tests, oral testing, redo opportunities
- Multiple-choice, true/false, fill-in-the-blank

4.5 What to Avoid

- Isolation through poor grouping structures
- Scolding and psychological burden
- Standardized-only testing
- Ignoring the problem

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5. GIFTED AND TALENTED STUDENT POLICY

5.1 Aim

HIS recognizes giftedness across academic and talent areas and provides differentiation, extension, enrichment, and acceleration within an inclusive framework.

5.2 Identification

Identification uses:

- Teacher recommendation checklist
- Parent information and peer observation
- Records of achievement and formal tests
- Extracurricular and group activities
- Differentiated curriculum opportunities

5.3 Curriculum Provision

Differentiation is provided by:

- Outcome, task, pace, and resources/materials

Extension and enrichment materials should:

- Allow individual responses
- Encourage creativity and imagination
- Match developmental stage

- Stress learning process, not only content

5.4 Monitoring and Assessment

- Set targets and monitor progress
- Celebrate achievement
- Provide intervention for underachieving gifted students

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6. ENGLISH LANGUAGE POLICY

6.1 Policy Statement

Students are expected to speak English at all times in school, unless involved in Arabic lessons. HIS enforces an “English Only” policy to support immersion and language development.

6.2 Rationale

English use:

- Develops communication skills
- Increases confidence and self-awareness
- Enhances learning across the curriculum
- Builds independence and maximizes potential

6.3 Implementation

If students speak languages other than English, teachers remind them of the policy and explain its purpose respectfully.

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7. HOMEWORK POLICY

7.1 Purpose

Homework supports academic achievement and responsibility. Completing assigned homework improves skills and performance.

7.2 Expectations and Support

For success, students need:

- A quiet, consistent place for homework.

- A schedule (preferably soon after returning home).
- Encouragement without parents doing the work for the child.
- Reasonable time: each assignment should be less than one hour.
- Healthy sleep routines.

7.3 Feedback

Teachers review homework for content and timeliness. Repeated late submission leads to parent contact and a support plan.

7.4 Homework Schedule Guidance

- Classwork is followed by related homework submitted next day/next period.
- Test/quiz requirements are listed in the schedule.

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8. TEST POLICY

8.1 Before the Test

Teachers must:

1. Submit test requirements at least three weeks before test date.
2. Ensure test questions are standards-based.
3. Use unified typed requirements format.
4. Send requirements to parents two weeks prior.
5. Submit tests to the coordinator two weeks before the test for revision.
6. Prepare and photocopy tests one week before.
7. Avoid testing more than one subject at once.

8.2 During the Test

Teachers must:

- Read questions and clarify instructions.
- Monitor and support inquiry without providing hints.
- Not correct tests during test time.

- Ensure no question is left unanswered.

8.3 After the Test

Teachers must:

- Correct within the same week.
- Record marks immediately.
- Not send test papers with students; parents may view at school.
- Analyze marks and send reports to parents.
- Send lists of unmet skills and implement remedial support.

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9. COACHING AND MENTORING NEW TEACHER POLICY

9.1 Rationale

New teachers face cultural, emotional, and instructional challenges. Mentoring supports innovation and developmentally appropriate teaching.

9.2 Coaching Components

- Regular meetings: school system, policies, teaching and learning policy.
- Pre-teaching planning: curriculum, annual plan, lesson plan, mapping, resources.
- Teacher handbook orientation.
- Professional development plan and training.
- Orientation visits, demo lessons, and observational classes.
- Peer mentoring and improvement plans.

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10. COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT POLICY

10.1 Philosophy

HIS values strong partnership with parents and community, recognizing parents as core contributors to educational success.

10.2 Communication

Parents are kept informed through:

- archived parent files, emails, phone contacts
- weekly plans, communication booklets, home letters, memos
- student/parent groups, counselor communication
- meetings, interviews, surveys

10.3 Complaints, Questions, Suggestions

A professional system exists to receive and respond promptly and honestly through reception and leadership follow-up.

10.4 Parents Group

A selected group (approximately 20 parents) supports school activities and feedback through meetings, calls, surveys, interviews, parties, and visits.

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11. SAFE ENVIRONMENT POLICY

HIS ensures a safe environment through:

- rubber playground flooring (12 cm, heat resistant)
- 27 fire hydrants; alarms per section; fire system in every room
- concrete roof upgrades; wide windows and air conditioning
- rubber-covered playground posts
- lab safety: sink, portable sand box; chemicals out of student reach
- teacher duty during breaks; separated break times by grade
- first aid kit and fire hose available
- roof ventilation design; rainwater pathway
- covered playground roofs for sun protection; dust prevention net

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12. HEALTHCARE POLICY

HIS supports student physical and mental health through:

- first aid-trained supervisor (no full-time nurse)
- emergency medical supplies in a mini fridge

- serious cases treated urgently; parents informed immediately
- frequent cleaning and sterilization of facilities
- soap and cleaners provided daily
- teacher hygiene awareness and student cleanliness monitoring

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13. UNSUITABLE WEATHER POLICY

13.1 Rationale

Clear guidelines ensure safety and supervision when weather prevents outdoor activity.

13.2 Responsibilities

- Section supervisor decides on policy implementation.
- Teachers/assistants supervise students in classrooms.
- Students follow instructions and move promptly to classes.

13.3 Procedures

- Decision before 7:15 a.m. communicated to staff.
- If mid-break, students return immediately; staff position for movement supervision.
- If severe dust, parents are informed to collect students.

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14. HOT WEATHER POLICY

When temperature exceeds 38°C:

- students remain indoors or shaded areas
- outdoor sport and practice are cancelled
- hydration is encouraged
- if comfort cannot be maintained (e.g., power failure), parents are contacted for early collection
- students must be signed out at the front office

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15. FIRE POLICY

15.1 Purpose

- proactive fire prevention and hazard identification
- safe evacuation and accounting for all persons
- support safe access for fire and rescue services

15.2 Arrangements

- fire risk assessments and checklist monitoring
- smoke alarms and fire alarm system with call points
- clear signs and notices; routes kept unblocked
- regular alarm testing and full fire drills
- extinguisher maintenance schedule
- storage cabinets for flammable materials

15.3 Responsibilities (All Staff)

- escort students/visitors to assembly point
- keep fire exits clear; do not wedge doors open
- cooperate in drills and report hazards
- avoid unauthorized electrical equipment
- store flammables appropriately after use

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16. TRANSPORTATION POLICY

HIS provides transport support through school buses regulated by a Transport Group Leader to ensure safe travel. Registration depends on availability; waiting list is maintained when buses are full. Parents provide a residence map for routing.

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17. DRESS CODE

Students wear school uniform daily. Teachers wear professional attire reflecting their role-model status. The uniform supports respect, discipline, unity, and loyalty to the school system.

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18. ASSEMBLY RULES

- teachers stand with their class respectfully
- maintain supervision and attentiveness
- no hot/soft drinks, side talks, or mobile phone use
- teachers maintain active, professional presence

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19. ATTENDANCE AND ABSENCE POLICY

19.1 Basic Rule

Attendance is mandatory. Students must be present at 6:45 a.m. for assembly; first period starts 7:00 a.m.; school ends 12:45 p.m.

19.2 Absence

Parents must contact school on the day of absence. Excused absence includes:

- illness
- extended illness (hospital permit)
- family death/emergency
- religious observances (pre-arranged)
- essential travel (inform at least one day prior)

19.3 Unexcused Absence

Absence without school notification is unexcused; student loses make-up rights as stated.

19.4 Tardiness

Late students are questioned by administration; parent informed if no reasonable excuse.

19.5 Make-up Work

Quizzes, tests, and exams will not be repeated; overall evaluation takes place instead. Students receive missed sheets; teachers compensate learning loss through schedule adjustments.

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20. ANTI-BULLYING POLICY

20.1 Definition

Bullying is repeated physical, psychological, social, or verbal harm by individuals or groups, including electronic methods, intended to cause distress.

20.2 Aims

- prevent bullying
- raise awareness and challenge attitudes
- increase understanding for victims
- build an anti-bullying ethos
- support school vision of a friendly atmosphere

20.3 Roles and Responsibilities

Administration maintains ethos, awareness, and procedure enforcement. Teachers model behavior, address bullying, challenge discriminatory language, and respond to concerns. Students report incidents and support a safe environment. Parents inform school, avoid direct parent-to-parent confrontation, and support school procedures.

20.4 Examples of Bullying

Physical assault, verbal abuse, prejudice, graffiti, offensive literature, symbols, name calling, teasing, damaging belongings, rumors, exclusion, malicious calls/texts, emails, online harassment.

20.5 Support for Victims

Immediate discussion opportunity, parent contact, ongoing support, escorted movement if needed, disciplinary steps to prevent recurrence.

20.6 Disciplinary Steps

Official warning, parent involvement, break/lunchtime isolation, fixed-term exclusion (1–5 days), permanent exclusion for repeated offenses. Internet bullying may lead to suspension or exclusion regardless of time of posting.

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21. HAIRCUT POLICY

School authorities decide appropriateness. Requirements include: clean shaven, neat hair, no exaggerated sideburns, no undercuts/tracks/lines, no tinted/colored hair, no long strands, no extreme shaving; clipper level 3 is the shortest acceptable.

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22. MOBILE DEVICE ACCEPTABLE USE POLICY

22.1 Rationale

Phones may be carried for safety, but misuse (photos/videos, class distraction) is not permitted.

22.2 Procedures

Students submit devices to the social worker each morning and collect them at the end of the day. Parents contact students through the office when needed.

22.3 Sanctions

Misuse or failure to submit devices results in confiscation; parents are informed and collect devices during office hours. Repeated cases lead to stricter follow-up.

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23. ADMISSION POLICY

KG1–KG3 accepted directly. Other grades sit diagnostic tests in English and Math. Placement is determined by results. Places are guaranteed only upon completion of documents and payment of fees. Students from HIS KG are admitted to Grade 1 without test. Students transferring from international/national/Arabic schools sit placement tests; remedial programs may apply. Students from Arabic schools above Grade 5 are generally not admitted due to curriculum and language foundation mismatch.

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24. MARKETING POLICY

Marketing is planned annually by leadership and finance. Methods include brochures, newspaper advertisements, KG graduation events, parent meetings, interviews, school website/social media updates, handbooks, and memos.

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25. RECRUITMENT POLICY

Recruitment steps:

1. Determine vacancies
2. Divide responsibilities (academic and administrative teams)
3. Announce vacancies
4. Travel for recruitment
5. Conduct interviews and evaluation
6. Visa procedures
7. Staff hosting and documentation
8. Training and induction before school starts

Applicant evaluation rubric includes: certificates, professional knowledge, English competency, minimum two years' experience, character/appearance, attitude.

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26. IMPLEMENTATION, MONITORING, AND RECORDS

26.1 Implementation

- Policies are introduced during staff induction and annual orientation.
- Coordinators ensure staff understand and apply procedures consistently.
- Parents and students are informed through handbooks and the school portal.

26.2 Monitoring

- Section supervisors and coordinators monitor compliance through observations, audits, and record review.
- Incident and safety logs are maintained where applicable.

- Policy breaches are addressed through the Code of Conduct and disciplinary procedures.

26.3 Records Management

Records may include (as relevant): attendance reports, safety drill logs, bullying incident reports, parent communication records, and academic monitoring reports. Records are treated confidentially.

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27. REVIEW AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

This manual is reviewed annually by the Principal and Academic Coordination Office with input from staff and parent representatives where appropriate. Updates are communicated before the start of each academic year.

End of Manual